Four-Barrel Carburetor Rebuild, Working Notes

My own shorthand for the 1987 C10 build. Pulled from forum threads and the rebuild kit instructions.

WHY THE FOUR-BARREL

Going from throttle body injection to a carburetor on the 87 C10. The spread bore four-barrel has small primaries for economy and big secondaries for when you get into it. Right call for a stock 350 that is not chasing big power, just a clean, honest running truck. Simpler to tune by hand at the garage than the old injection setup, and parts are easy to get through the counter.

BEFORE YOU START

- Take photos of every linkage and vacuum line before anything comes off. You will forget.
- Lay parts out in order. An egg carton or a muffin tin works for the small stuff.
- Work clean. One speck of grit in a jet and you chase a problem for a week.
- Fresh gasket kit on the bench, and a clean drain pan under the carb for the old fuel.

TEARDOWN ORDER

- Air horn screws, lift the top straight up so you do not bend the floats.
- Note the float level and which accelerator pump linkage hole is being used.
- Primary and secondary metering rods, keep them paired to their springs.
- Jets out, label primary versus secondary. Do not mix them.
- Power piston, check it moves free and springs back.

THE TWO KNOWN WEAK SPOTS

Fuel well plugs in the bottom of the float bowl leak with age. Epoxy the wells on reassembly, which lines up with what the carb-build channel does and what the forum keeps repeating. The throttle shaft wears and pulls a vacuum leak. Check for slop before you trust it, and plan to bush it later if it is loose.

REASSEMBLY

- New float, set the level to spec with the kit gauge. Too high floods, too low starves.
- New accelerator pump, work it by hand, you should see a clean squirt.
- Idle mixture screws, seat gently then back out about 2.5 turns to start.
- New gaskets throughout, do not reuse the old bowl gasket even if it looks fine.

BENCH SETTINGS TO START WITH

Setting	Starting point
Idle mixture screws	2.5 turns out from seated
Float level	to kit gauge spec
Idle speed (warm)	650 to 700 rpm in drive
Fuel pressure (carb)	5 to 7 psi, low pressure pump
Accelerator pump shot	clean stream, no dribble

TUNING ONCE RUNNING

Warm it up first. Set idle speed, then set idle mixture by vacuum for the highest steady reading, backing each screw a hair at a time. Watch for a stumble off idle, which is usually the accelerator pump shot or the squirter size. Small changes, then drive it, then adjust again. Do not chase everything at once.

FIRST START CHECKLIST

- Prime the bowl, do not crank it dry forever.
- Fire extinguisher within reach. Fuel up top, take it seriously.
- Watch every fitting for leaks before you let it idle.
- Set timing once it catches and warms.

PARTS STILL TO SORT

Confirm the carb to intake bolt pattern with Jake before ordering the gasket set. Decide whether to keep the throttle body distributor with a module or step up to a vacuum advance unit for the carburetor. Leaning toward the simpler distributor route to save money and keep the first start uncomplicated.

QUESTIONS FOR JAKE

Will the stock alternator keep up once it is running again? Is the old fuel line worth reusing, or should the whole run go to a carb friendly low pressure setup? He sees this stuff all day at the parts counter, so a two minute call saves a wrong order. Text him before the next garage Saturday so the parts are in when Dad is around.